

Video:

Under the Video tab, choose the resolution rate for output

Choose the base canvas resolution as 1920 x 1080 and the Output resolution as 1920 x 1080 or whatever you want your stream to be. Always remember that streaming in a higher output resolution with lower bitrate will drop your stream quality. The two parameters have to match. You can refer to the platform guidelines to know how the optimal values.

Also, the frame rate takes up a lot of data. Doubling the frame rate from 30 FPS to 60 FPS literally doubles the upload bandwidth requirement. Again, each platform as limits on frame rates and for most streams 30 FPS is more than enough. You can switch to 60 when you upgrade to a better internet plan. On YouTube, a 4K stream with 60 FPS requires a bitrate of 20,000 to 51,000 Kbps. That means you need a steady upload bandwidth

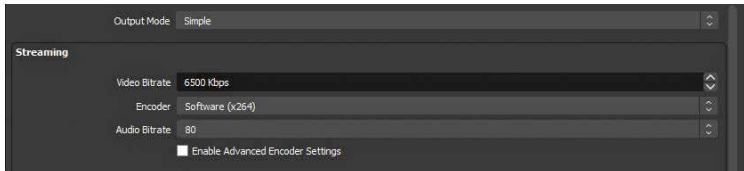


Figure 5: Streaming of output mode (video bitrate and audio bitrate selection)

of 50 MBps and each hour will take up close to 22 GB of data. If your plan is generous with data and bandwidth, go for it. If not, switch to something more sensible.

Encoder:

Changing encoder settings is vital for good streaming. Encoders compress your video to be compatible with as many devices as possible. You have to choose the encoder depending on the expected output balancing the compatibility, size, and quality. For a functional quality video, changing the configuration setting is recommended.

Most software packages have an encoder as a part of the application. In OBS, x.264 is used. If you have additional hardware such as an NVIDIA graphics card, then you might see options for additional encoders such as NVENC. Picking NVENC will cause OBS to use the graphics card for encoding the video and free up your CPU for other work. However, not all encoders provide the exact same video quality. Discrete capture cards are usually capable of higher quality captures.